

CULTUREHUB LOS ANGELES · RESIDENCY 2026 · SEPTEMBER 16–25

Whistlegraph presents.

Special Sign + MacNeoPolitan

Two works for laptop ensemble. Six salvaged laptops pulled back from e-waste, and three brand-new MacBook Neos. It is the same instrument either way — and that is the argument.

The program

TWO WORKS · NINE LAPTOPS

WORK ONE · LIVE SPATIAL VERSION

Special Sign

A composition for twelve moving sound bodies, expanded live from a fixed 1:41 recording. Six salvaged laptops, booted into **AC Native** and running **notepat**, become one distributed instrument inside the 5:1 Kalio surround. From a live control surface Jeffrey rotates the whole field, changes its speed and trajectory, and redistributes its voices among the computers.

It can go differently every time it is played.

WORK TWO · NEW · A SPATIAL AUDIO PLAY

MacNeoPolitan

Three MacBook Neos — indigo, citrus, blush — each played through **Menu Band**, the menu-bar piano. Three flavors in a block.

The keyboard sits at the top of the screen beside the clock, the WiFi, and the battery. That placement is the whole argument: an instrument should be a built-in facility of a computer, not an application you go out and get.

Why they pair

One work runs on machines people threw away. One runs on machines bought new off the shelf. **notepat** and **Menu Band** share a lineage and a keymap — Menu Band is the accessible descendant. Putting them on one program turns a single expanded track into an argument about hardware indifference, and it gives the residency's e-waste premise something to push against.

Technical note that governs all copy. AC Native is x86_64 UEFI only — it boots [EFI/B00T/B00TX64.EFI](#) and cannot run on Apple Silicon. *MacNeoPolitan* therefore runs **Menu Band**, a shipping universal macOS app, and no port is required. **Never write that AC Native runs on Apple hardware.**

Public programs

PROPOSED · PENDING CONFIRMATION

WHEN	WHAT	NOTES
Sat Sep 19 2:00–3:30 pm	Menu Band Jam	Bring a Mac and install Menu Band — free, open source, about a minute. Bring any other laptop and boot AC Native from a USB stick, which changes nothing on the disk. No programming or musical experience required; loaners available.
Thu Sep 24 7:00–8:00 pm	Performance & conversation	Both works performed inside the surround field, audience seated in the score. ~40 minutes of music, then a conversation. Livestream requested; platform TBD.

Media

CONTACT SHEET · APPROVAL NEEDED

Everything currently available to the campaign, with its status. Two slots are still open: the two-work event image, and the final portrait selection.

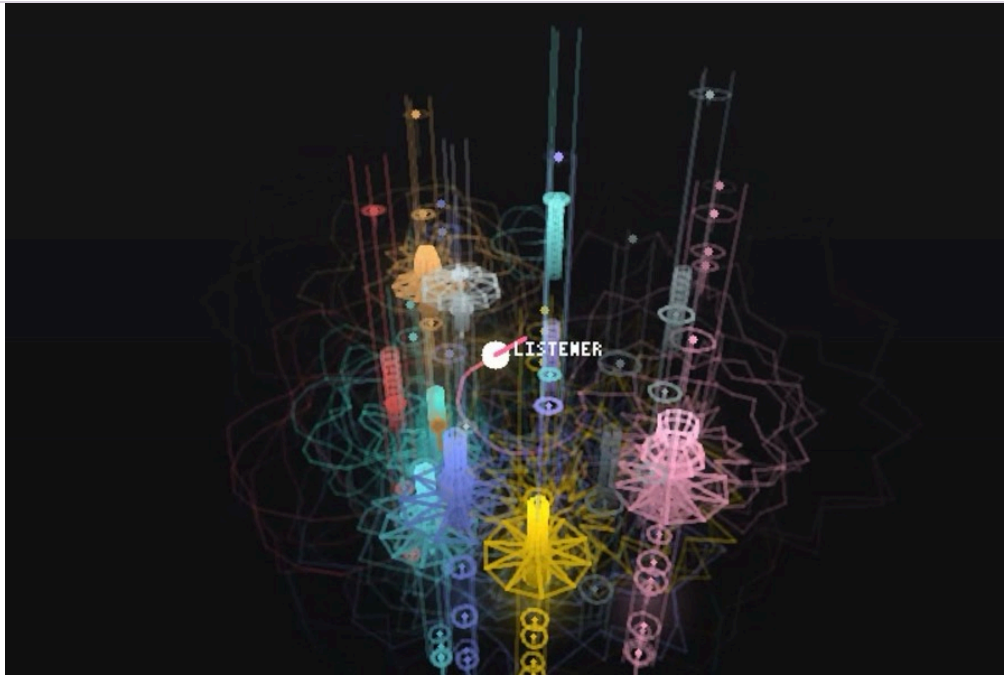


Special Sign — release cover

APPROVED

special-sign-cover-3000.jpg · 3000×3000 · canonical

The *Attic Gremlin* colored-pencil cover: Jeffrey mid-leap with a green laptop beside the spatial sine globe, cables running to it across an attic studio. Establishes the house illustration style — visible hatching, paper tooth, no wash. Note the green laptop, which rhymes with the citrus MacBook Neo.

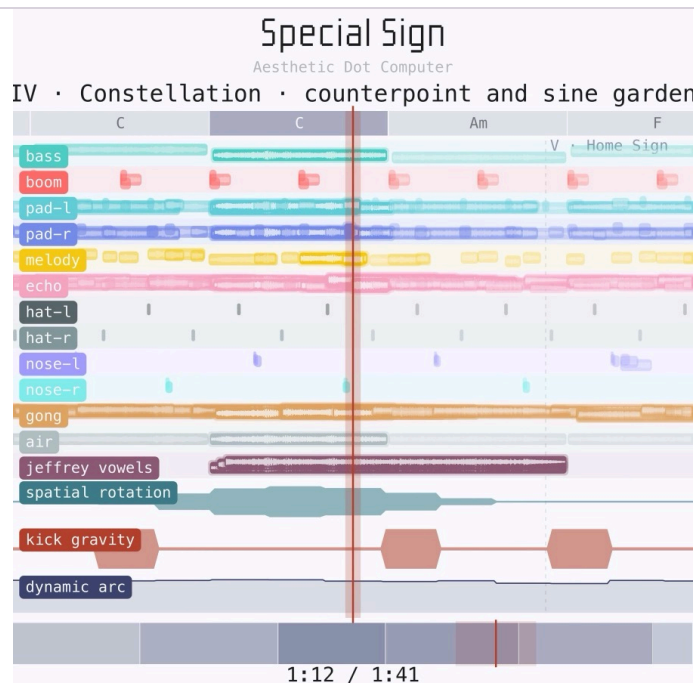


3D spatial overview — still

INTERIM

special-sign-live-spatial-3x2.jpg · 1800×1200 · frame @ 1:12

Twelve translucent wireframe bodies rise as glowing columns from a dark field, threaded by note lanes and starburst markers, with a looping petal-shaped path around them. The white dot labelled LISTENER sits at centre. Currently the interim event-page image.

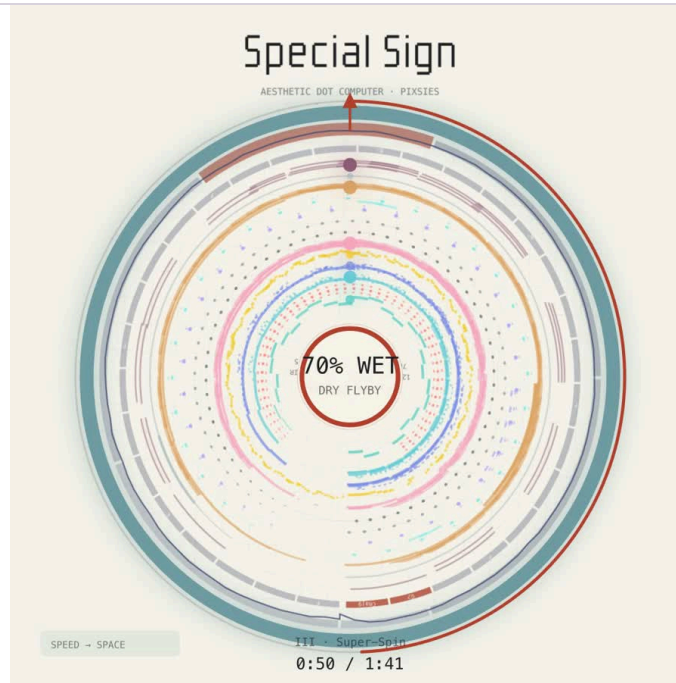


Graphic score — moving

APPROVED

special-sign-graphic-score.mp4 · 2160² · frame @ 1:12

Thirteen named lanes — bass, boom, pad-l/r, melody, echo, hats, noses, gong, air, *jeffrey vowels* — over spatial rotation, kick gravity, and dynamic arc. Section IV, “Constellation · counterpoint and sine garden.” The clearest single image of how the piece is actually built.



Circular score — moving

APPROVED

special-sign-circular-score.mp4 · frame @ 0:50

The radial score under a fixed receiver needle, reading 70% WET at the Super-Spin section. Shows the speed-to-wetness mapping that the live version puts under hand control — the single best illustration of what “played in real time” means here.



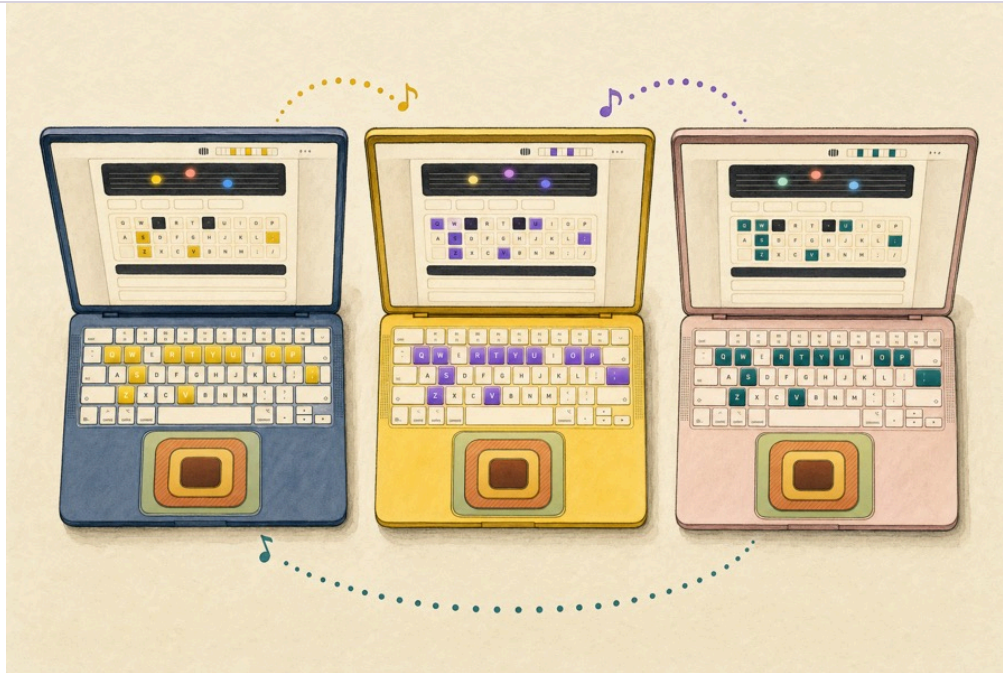
Notepat Jam — showroom illustration

SUPERSEDE

notepat-jam-3x2.png = header.png · 3:2 · live on the public page

Six salvaged laptops ringed on plywood tables, lids turned screens-away, colored glow on every face, audience seated low inside the ring. Still accurate for *Special Sign* and still the hero on the public page — but it predates *MacNeoPolitan* and shows no MacBook Neos.

Three illustrations for the new work, in the house colored-pencil style. Colorways verified against Apple; the twelve notepat semitone keys and the TrackDrum zone map are drawn from the source, not from memory.



The Neapolitan block

APPROVED

gens/block.png · 1536×1024 · gpt-image-2

Three MacBook Neos overhead — indigo, citrus, blush. All twelve notepat semitone keycaps are coloured on each machine: Q W R T Y U O P across the top row, S and the apostrophe on the home row, Z and V below. E and I stay white naturals. Trackpads carry the TrackDrum instrument map — hi-hat, snare, tom, kick. A note passes machine to machine and one long arc closes the circle.

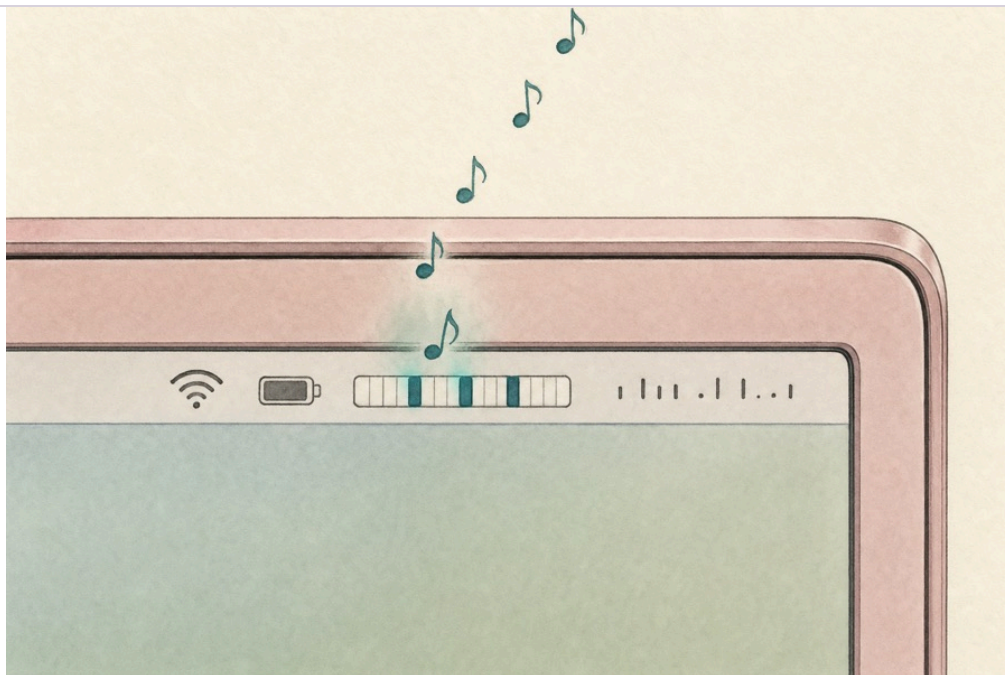


Jeffrey inside the ring

APPROVED

gens/trio.png · 1536×1024 · gpt-image-2

The three machines turned inward around a seated listener, personified by posture alone. Every screen carries the real Menu Band interface. The chalk ring on the floorboards is the shared downbeat — three separate computers, no cable between them, one pulse.



A piano beside the clock

APPROVED

gens/menubar.png · 1536×1024 · gpt-image-2

The argument in one frame: WiFi, battery, a small segmented keyboard, and the time — all the same size in the same row on a blush machine. The instrument is a built-in facility, not an application.

The two-work image

EVENT PAGE · BOTH WORKS

The whole program in one frame — the image the event page runs. Colored pencil, matching the *Special Sign* cover and the existing public-page header rather than the MacNeoPolitan house style, because it has to sit across both works.



Nine laptops

APPROVED

gens/program.png · 1536×1024 · gpt-image-2

Three new MacBook Neos open across the front — indigo, citrus, blush — screens toward the viewer with the lit menu-bar keyboard strip visible on each. Six salvaged laptops ring behind, mismatched and visibly older, screens full of coloured pads, PALS stickers on the lids. A listener sits between the two groups. The old/new contrast is the pitch, and this is the only image that carries both halves.

Canon

WHAT THE ART IS CHECKED AGAINST

The four sources every *MacNeoPolitan* image is verified against. None of these are drawn from memory — the colourway comes from Apple, the drum and the keymap come out of the source code, and the interface is a real screenshot.



The four colourways

REFERENCE

Apple Newsroom press photo · © Apple

MacBook Neo shipped March 2026 in *blush*, *indigo*, *silver* and *citrus* — there is no “blueberry” and no “rose.” Measured inside the lids: blush #dfc7c7, indigo #495369, citrus #d8d680. The citrus test is R ≈ G: real citrus is R216 G214, a true yellow. Anything where green leads red has drifted to chartreuse, which is the mistake every early take made.

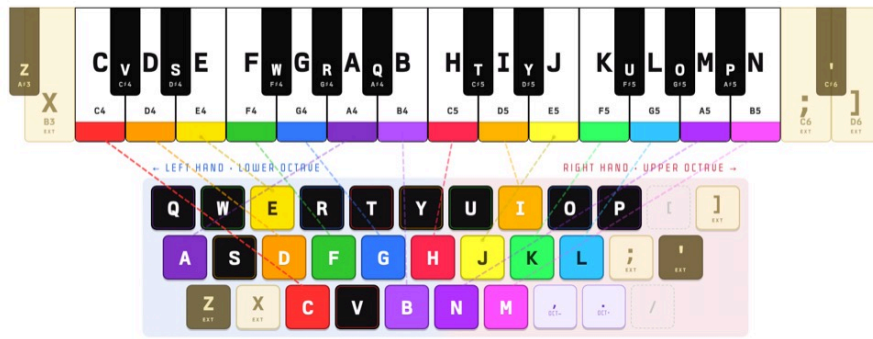


TrackDrum

REFERENCE

rendered from Sources/TrackDrumIcon.swift

Not a membrane with ripples — an outside-to-centre instrument map: sage hi-hat, terracotta snare with diagonal wires, ochre tom, dark umber kick. The two touch dots and tether were removed from the source at Jeffrey's request; nothing rests on the zones. Re-render with [render-icon.sh](https://github.com/jeffrey-hewitt/render-icon.sh) after any change to that file.

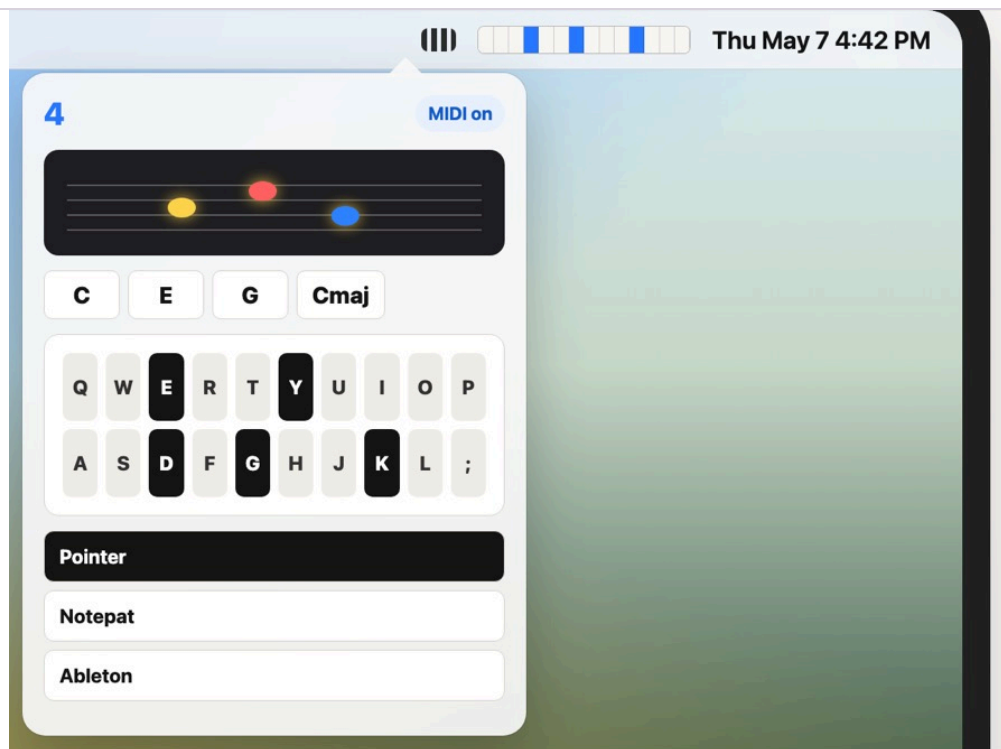


The twelve semitones

REFERENCE

notepat keymap · derived from labelByMidiNotepat

Semitones are $\text{midi} \% 12 \in \{1, 3, 6, 8, 10\}$: z=A#3, v=C#4, s=D#4, w=F#4, r=G#4, q=A#4, t=C#5, y=D#5, u=F#5, o=G#5, p=A#5, '=C#6. Twelve, not eleven — the apostrophe sits at the top of the range and was missing from the first four takes. E and I are naturals and stay unpainted.



Menu Band

REFERENCE

Mac App Store screenshot · the real interface

The menu-bar item is a small multi-segment keyboard beside the clock. The popover carries a staff with coloured note-dots, chord chips, the layout picker, and the three modes — Pointer, Notepat, Ableton. *MacNeoPolitan* runs the Notepat layout, which is why the machines carry the notepat twelve and not the popover's own compact map.

Portrait options

ONE MUST BE CHOSEN



Headshot — plain portrait

ALTERNATE

jeffrey-alan-scudder-headshot-3x2.jpg · animated .webp/.gif also prepared

Close portrait against deep blue, broad smile; the animated WebP cuts from a sideways smile to this one. Warmest as a portrait, but it shows him beside a computer rather than playing one. Now offered as the fallback if CultureHub wants a plain headshot.



Headshot — green laptop

SELECTED

...-3x2-green-laptop.jpg

Holding an open, heavily stickered laptop lit green from the screen. Reads as “person who plays computers” rather than “portrait,” and the sticker-covered lid tells the salvage story instantly. **Chosen for the artist page.**



Headshot — seated

ALTERNATE

...-3x2-seated.jpg

Seated against a plaster wall in daylight, red glasses and a yellow pencil on the shirt, bag over the shoulder. Calmest and most editorial; best if CultureHub's page runs portraits large.

Copy — what exists

WRITTEN AND READY

FILE	CONTENTS	STATE
ARTIST-PAGE.md	Bio, two-work project statement, links, headshot metadata and alt text	Ready to send
EVENT-PAGE.md	Public-program copy, both works, audience interaction, proposed dates	Ready; dates provisional
ANNOUNCE.md	Press blurb, one-liner, four social posts, calendar listings	Written, embargoed
POSTER.md	Art direction, generation prompt, crop sizes, typography	Brief only — art not made
TECH-RIDER.md	Both works, two patches, clock sync, power, changeover, risks	Ready to send
web-draft/	Rewritten public page, keeps the submitted proposal as record	Held for embargo
packet/*.tex	Artist page, event page, rider, send manifest	Stale — needs rebuild

Open items

WHAT IS ACTUALLY BLOCKING

BY	ITEM	NOTE
Aug 11	Artist-page materials due	Copy and headshot are ready. Only the portrait choice is outstanding.
Aug 16	Technical rider	Rewritten for both works. Send once CultureHub names a technical contact.
—	Clock sync	Needs outbound NTP and client-to-client ssh on the house network. Verify at the technical rehearsal — a smeared downbeat still plays, it just sounds wrong.
—	Workshop Wi-Fi	Menu Band Jam participants install the app on the day; guest Wi-Fi must allow downloads.
—	Two-work event image	Brief is written; art not yet generated.
—	Third MacBook Neo (blush)	Not purchased. Do not describe its finish in copy until it is in hand.
—	MacNeoPolitan score	New work. Not yet written or rehearsed on all three machines.
—	Packet PDFs	No xelatex on this Mac — rebuild on neo or in the devcontainer.
—	CultureHub confirmations	Corrected LOA, event dates, equipment inventory.

Production risk. One of the three MacBook Neos is neo, the working dev machine, which is documented as exhausting its 8 GB of RAM and hanging under load. A hang during MacNeoPolitan would stop the piece. Decide now whether neo performs from a clean boot with nothing else running, or whether a fourth machine stands by — not on September 23.